ture—ensuring that the architecture is secure and configured correctly, that there is necessary visibility into the architecture and, importantly, into who is accessing it.

1. Learn your responsibilities. This may sound obvious, but security is handled a little differently in the cloud. Public cloud providers such as AWS, Microsoft Azure and GCP run a shared responsibility model—they ensure security of the cloud, while you are responsible for anything you place in the cloud.

2. Plan for multi-cloud. Multi-cloud is no longer a nice-to-have strategy; rather, it has become a must-have strategy. There are many reasons why you may want to use multiple clouds, such as availability, improved agility or functionality. When planning your security strategy, start with the assumption that you will run multi-cloud—if not now, at some point in the future. This way you can future-proof your approach.

3. See everything. If you cannot see it, you cannot secure it. That is why one of the biggest requirements to getting your security posture right is getting accurate visibility of all your cloud-based infrastructure, configuration settings, API calls and user access.

4. Integrate compliance into daily processes. The dynamic nature of the public cloud means that continuous monitoring is the only way to ensure compliance with many regulations. The best way to achieve this is to integrate compliance into daily activities, with real-time snapshots of the network topology and real-time alerts to any changes.

5. Automate security controls. Cybercriminals increasingly take advantage of automation in their attacks. Stay ahead of hackers by automating your defenses, including remediation of vulnerabilities and anomaly reporting.

6. Secure all environments (including dev and QA). You need a solution that can secure all your environments (production, development and quality assurance, or QA) both reactively and proactively.

7. Apply on-premises security learnings. On-premises security is the result of decades of experience and research. Use firewalls and server protection to secure your cloud assets against infection and data loss, and keep your endpoint and email security up-to-date on your devices to prevent unauthorised access to cloud accounts.

Moving from traditional to cloud-based workloads offers huge opportunities for organisations of all sizes. Yet, securing the public cloud is imperative if you wish to protect your infrastructure and organisation from cyberattacks. By following the above-mentioned seven steps, you can maximise the security of your public clouds, while also simplifying management and compliance reporting. EFY